

POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

DEMOCRACY AT WORK MODULE-6



ELECTIONS IN INDIA

VOTER AWARENESS FORUMS



No Voter to be Left Behind



POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

INDIA - FREEDOM STRUGGLE COMMITTED TO ESTABLISHMENT OF DEMOCRACY.

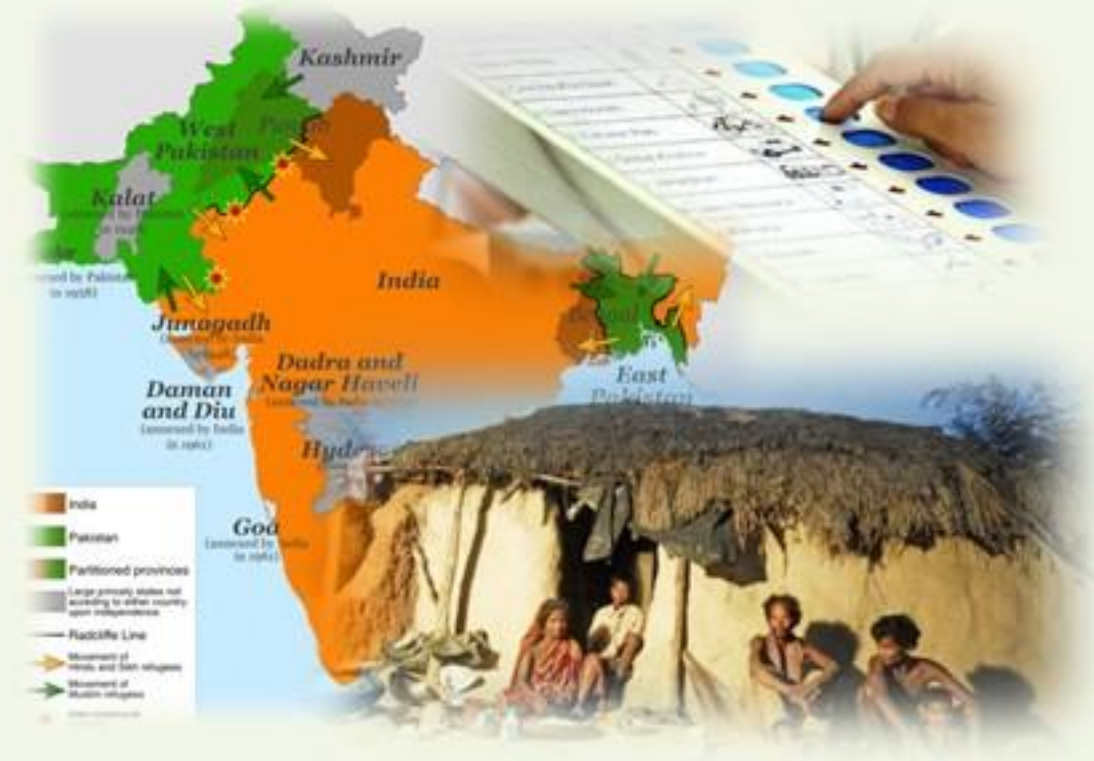
BEGINNING OF DEMOCRACY IN INDIA



- Process of establishment of democracy began with the enactment of Constitution in 1950.
- Democracy respected differences.
- Challenge of establishing democracy in a country when unity was disturbed.
- Generally newly independent country- non democratic.

CHALLENGE OF ESTABLISHING OF DEMOCRACY IN INDIA

- The country had to be divided into constituencies by the Delimitation Commission.
- Electoral rolls had to be prepared. There was humungous task of registering the voters.
- The electorate in India constituted 176 million aged 21 years or more.
- 85 percent of this population was illiterate.



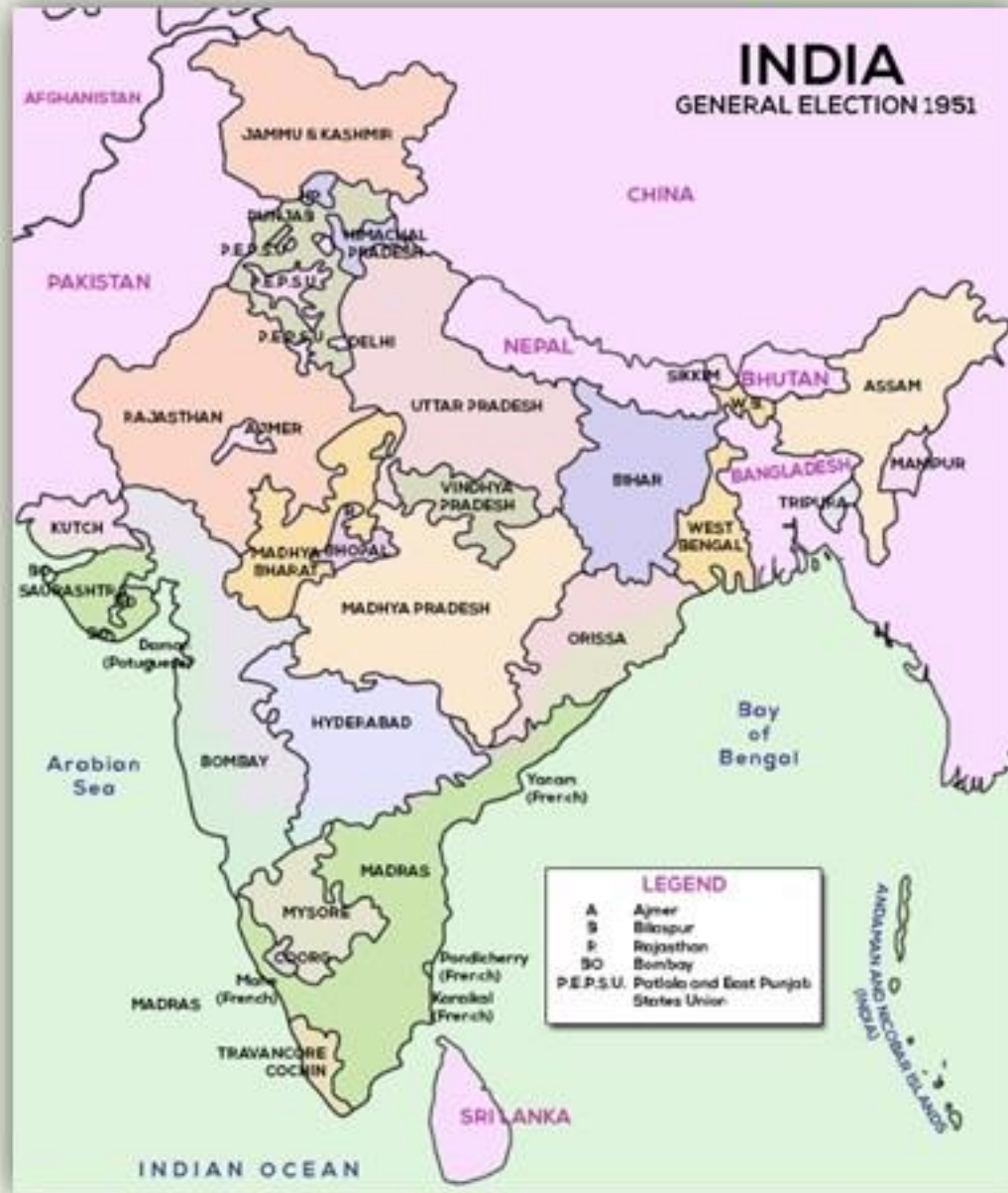
CHALLENGE OF ESTABLISHING OF DEMOCRACY IN INDIA



- Women had to be given voting rights.
- Diverse society having multiple identities.
- Party symbols had to be designed, ballot boxes and ballot papers had to be prepared. The party symbols were to be chosen from daily life.
- Variety of ink was used to avoid impersonation.
- Polling officers were to be recruited.
- State elections were to be held parallelly.
- There was lack of political awareness among people. Film and Radio was used to educate public on how to practice democracy. There was also door-to-door publicity.

POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

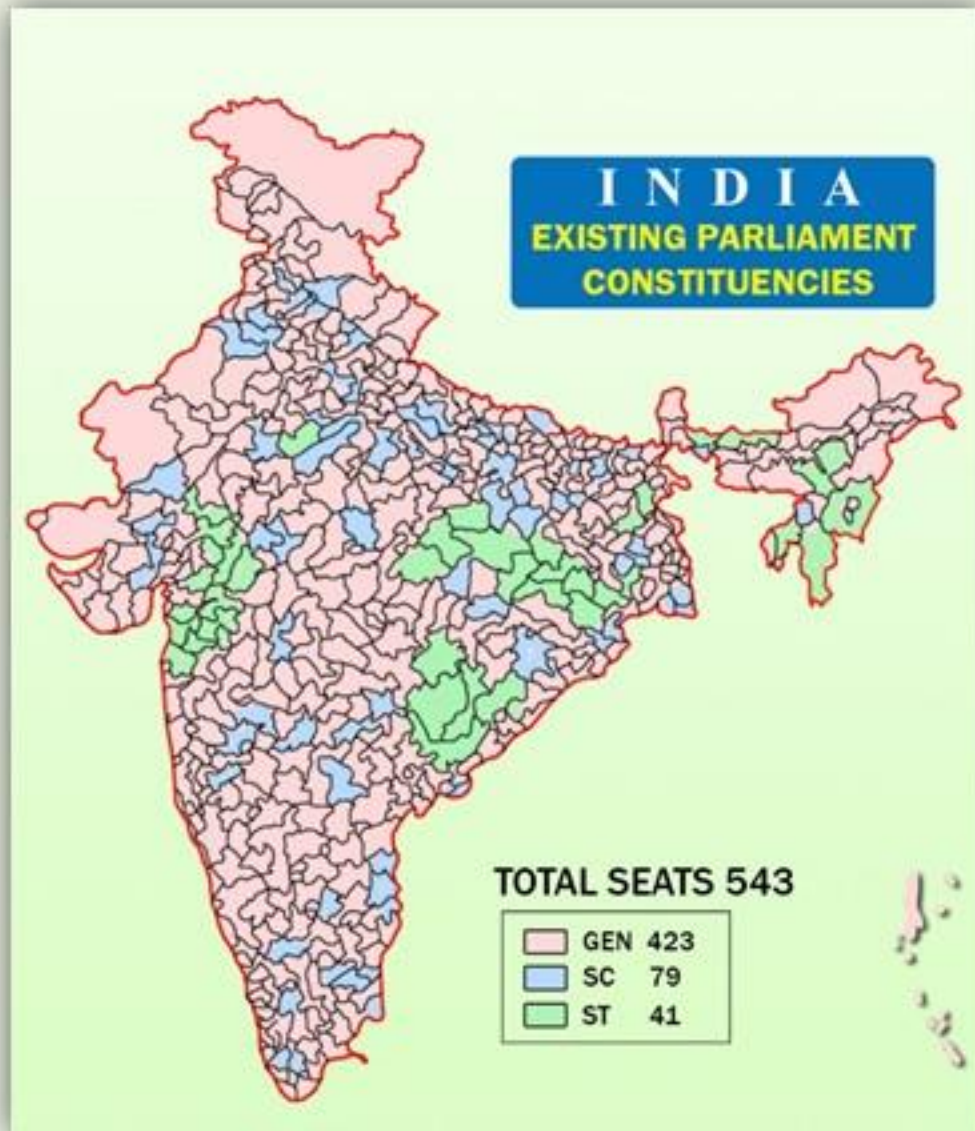
FIRST ELECTION OF INDIA



- First Election in India was based on Universal Adult Franchise.
- Postponed twice and held finally between October 1951 and February 1952-more than half of the voters turned out to vote.
- Free, fair and peaceful elections held.
- A group of Buddhist peasants of Himachal Pradesh were the first Indians to vote on 25 October 1951.
- 60 percent of the registered voters exercised their franchise in the first general elections on the system of 'First past the post'.
- About 28 Congress ministers including BR Ambedkar did not get elected.
- The general elections proved that literacy was not a test for intelligence.

POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

DELIMITATION COMMISSION



- Appointed by the President of India and worked in collaboration with Election Commission of India.
- It is appointed for the purpose of drawing up the boundaries of constituencies all over the country.
- Quota of constituencies to be reserved in each state is fixed depending on the proportion of SC or ST in the state.
- After drawing the boundaries, the Delimitation Commission looks at the composition of population in each constituency.
- Those constituencies that have the highest proportion of Scheduled Tribe population are reserved for ST.
- These reserved constituencies can be rotated each time the Delimitation exercise is undertaken.

ELECTION COMMISSION OF INDIA



- India's first general elections were an act of faith.
- The Election Commission of India was set up and the Representation of India Act was passed on 12 May 1950.
- Sukumar Sen was appointed the Chief Election Commissioner on 21 March 1950.
- Sukumar Sen was born in 1898. He was educated in Presidency College and at London University. He won a gold medal in mathematics. He joined ICS in 1921 and was appointed the Chief Secretary of West Bengal in 1947. He finally became the Chief Election Commissioner.

POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

HINDRANCES TO J.L. NEHRU'S VICTORY



- Angry refugees from East and West Pakistan.
- States of South and Sikhs of North were restless.
- Kashmir question was unresolved.

Reformer-

- Nehru campaigned to abolish untouchability and landlordism. He encouraged the women to take off the purdah and participate in national integration.
- J.L. Nehru was admired for not centralizing power and establishing democracy.

WHY INDIAN NATIONAL CONGRESS?

Indian National Congress - won 364 out of 489 seats



- Formed in 1885 as a pressure group for the newly educated, professional and commercial class.
- Inherited the legacy of national movement- freedom fighters were largely Congress leaders.
- Well organized party, well strategized especially reaching the local level.
- Have a national reach.
- Widened social base.

Ambitions of leaders accommodated- all factions/groups continued to remain within

WHY INDIAN NATIONAL CONGRESS?

INDIAN NATIONAL CONGRESS



- Coalition of organisations having diverse social interests.
- All inclusive approach - representation from diverse classes, castes and religions got themselves heard.
- Ideological coalition
 - ✓ Accommodated the conservatives as well as the radicals.
 - ✓ Platform for numerous groups.
 - ✓ Integration of diverse opinion.
- PM Nehru was a charismatic leader.

PM NEHRU



JL Nehru's ideology rested on four main pillars-

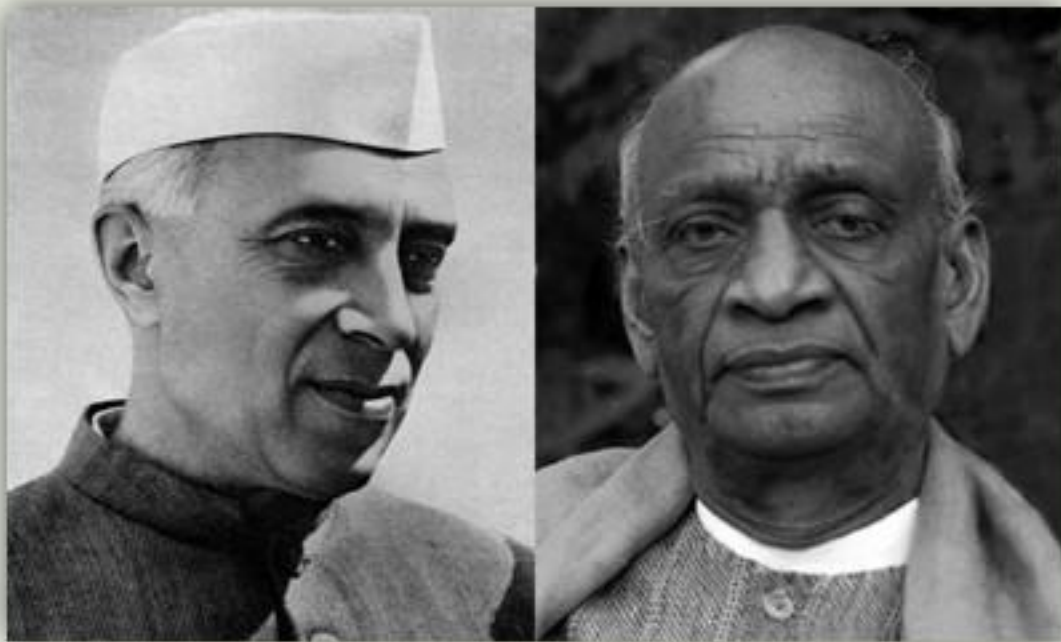
- **Democracy** - right to representation, freedom of speech and expression. Multiparty system with autonomy of Judiciary and Executive.
- **Secularism** - State was to remain neutral on religious matters, no state religion and need to maintain social peace.
- **Socialism** - expand production while ensuring equitable distribution of powers.
- **Non-Alignment**- Not aligning with any of the superpowers and focusing on a sovereign foreign policy.

JL NEHRU & SARDAR PATEL



- JL Nehru and Sardar Patel were different in character and personality.
- Nehru was Brahmin from upper class with family history in the nationalist movement. Sardar Patel was from the farming caste with family history in the Sepoy mutiny.
- Nehru liked travelling, wine, art and literature. Patel, on the other hand, was a non-smoker and teetotaler.

JL NEHRU & SARDAR PATEL



- Nehru preferred state control over the economy and Patel was friendly to the capitalist. They also differed on questions of morality and matters of philosophy.
- With the death of Mahatma Gandhi, Nehru and Patel came closer.
- With the death of Sardar Patel in December 1950, there was only one power center in the Congress.

OPPOSITION IN INDIA



Indian National Congress
(Two bulls with yoke on)



Socialist Party
(Tree)



Forward Bloc (Raijkar Group)
(Human hand)



Communist Party of India
(Ears of corn and a sickle)



Revolutionary Socialist Party
(Spade and stoker)



Krishikar Lok Party
(A cultivator winnowing grain)

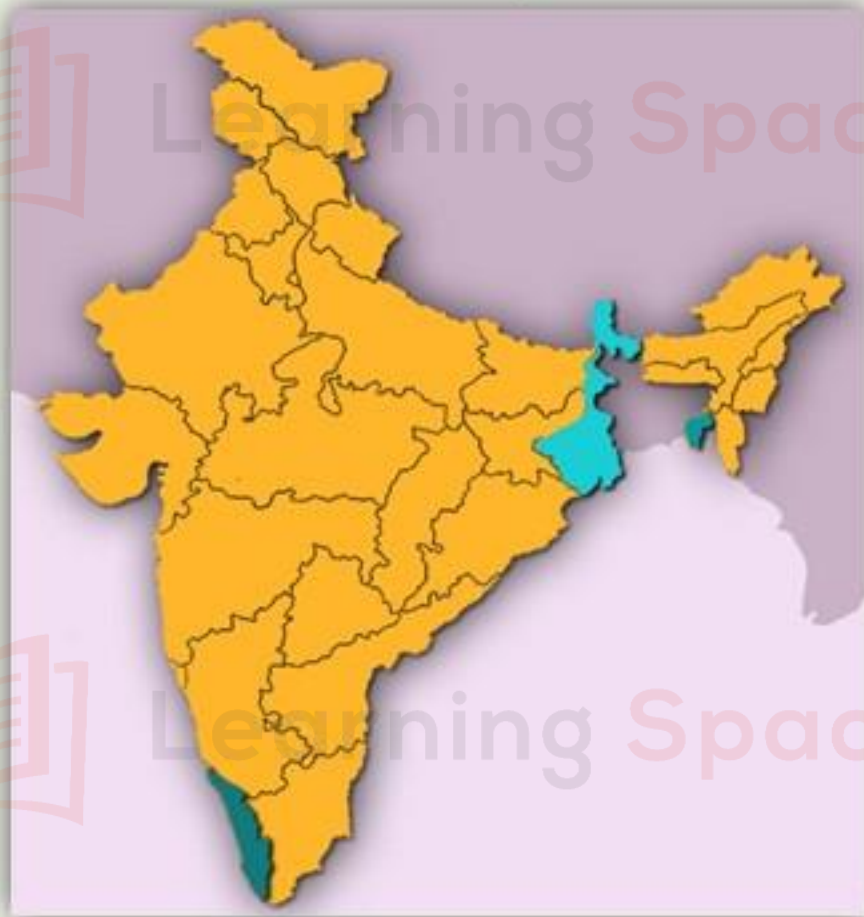


- Opposition parties were diverse and created pressure on Congress to maintain a vibrant democracy.
- When the inclusive character of the Congress declined and it was unable to accommodate multiple interests, opposition parties strengthened

Result - Multi-party system with Congress enjoying majority



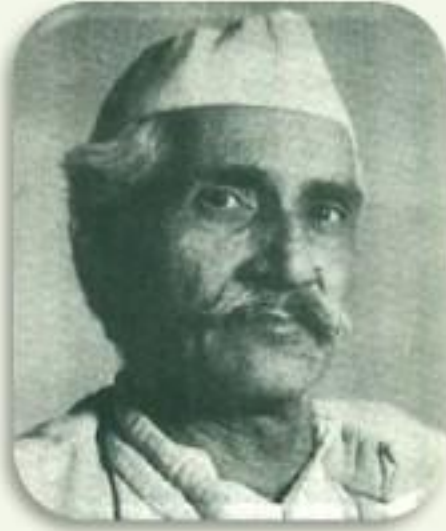
COMMUNIST PARTY



- Inspired by Bolshevik Revolution in Russia.
- Followed socialism.
- In 1941, Communists decided to support the British in their war against Nazi Germany.
- Most concentrated in Andhra Pradesh, West Bengal, Bihar and Kerala.
- Important leaders- AK Gopalan, SA Dange, PC Joshi, Ajay Ghosh, P. Sundararaya



SOCIALIST PARTY



Acharya Narendra Dev

1948 - Socialist Party
Little electoral success.

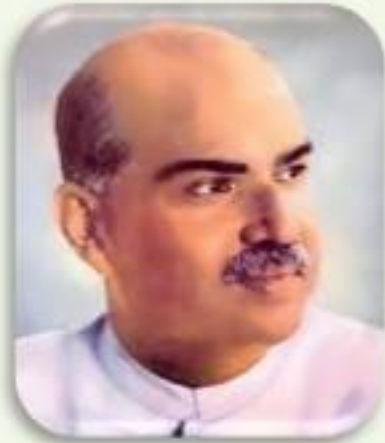
- Roots laid in the pre-independence era as the Congress Socialist Party started in 1934.
- Founded by Acharya Narendra Dev.
 - ✓ Freedom fighter
 - ✓ Buddhist scholar
 - ✓ Peasant movements organized

OBJECTIVE

- Radical and egalitarian society.
- Believed in democratic socialism - different from Congress and Communists.
- Criticized the Congress as they favored the capitalists and landlords and ignored the workers and peasants.



BHARTIYA JANA SANGH



**Dr. Shyama Prasad
Mookerji**

- Founded in 1951 by Shyama Prasad Mukherjee.
- Other leaders were
 - ✓ Deen Dayal Upadhaya
 - ✓ Balraj Madhok

*Bhartiya Jana Sangh led to the birth of **Bhartiya Janata Party**.*

Politician & academician **Syama Prasad Mukherjee** was born on July 6, 1901

FOUNDER OF BHARATIYA JANA SANGH

Founded Bharatiya Jana Sangh, which later evolved into **BHARATIYA JANATA PARTY (BJP)** in 1951, after parting ways with Nehru

Started his political career in 1929 by becoming a **member of the Bengal Legislative Council**

In 1939, **joined Hindu Mahasabha** to take up the cause of Hindus

Was also a **Vice-Chancellor** of the University of Calcutta

Was opposed to the decision to grant special status to J&K; in 1953 visited Kashmir where he was arrested





BHARTIYA JANA SANGH



1 NATION
CULTURE

- It finds its roots in pre-independent organisations - Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) and the Hindu Mahasabha.
- Ideology- One country and one Nation and opposed the partition for the idea of Akhand Bharat.
- BJS believed the country could become strong only on the basis of Indian culture and traditions.
- It stood for Hindi to be made the official language.
- It advocated India to develop nuclear weapons after China tested in 1964.
- It did not perform well in the general elections and was supported mainly from the Hindi speaking states like Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Delhi and Uttar Pradesh.



SWATANTRA PARTY



OBJECTIVE

- Leaders like C. Rajagopalachari, KM Munshi, NG Ranga and Minoo Masani formed the Swatantra party on 4 June 1959.
- They supported minimal state interference in controlling the economy.
- They stood to promote free private sector. It believed that the State should interfere in the economy only to promote development of the marginalized sections.



SWATANTRA PARTY



- It gained strength by attracting landlords, princes, industrialists and businessmen.
- In 1920, at the Nagpur Session the Congress called for land ceilings, food-grain trade and cooperative farming
- It did not support non-alignment movement after independence and proposed stronger relations with United States instead of Soviet Union.

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